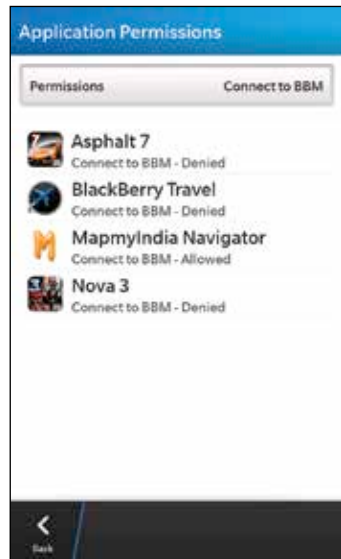


tweaks we hope to see in upcoming OS updates from BlackBerry, especially now that with the QNX platform, the devices are certainly capable of such advanced functionality.

BBM connected apps

There is another aspect of BBM that BlackBerry is pushing, which is BBM Connected Apps. Though this actually launched with OS 7/7.1, it's only now that more apps are becoming available. This is basically some of your apps getting direct access to BBM, and being able to update your BBM automatically. Take for example the Facebook app; if you connect that to BBM, your BBM status will change automatically when you update your Facebook status. Not all apps work with statuses only though, and some may just connect with BBM to seamlessly allow you to send something as a BBM chat. Take BlackBerry Travel or Foursquare for example, where you can update plans on BBM, set any location you check into on Foursquare as a status, or the hotel you're staying at via BlackBerry Travel, etc. This keeps your friends up to date with what's happening with you, and you may get a few "I'm there too!" BBMs as well.



BBM Groups

From your BBM chat client, you can start or join a group. Say you have a lot of family on your BBM messenger. Using this Group function you can start a group and start chatting, sharing pictures, lists, make appointments, etc. Now in a family group, everyone might be on everyone else's contact list, so perhaps it seems a little similar to inviting people into a group chat. But what about, say, a group of people working on a project for work. These may be people who may or may not be on each other's lists, but need to stay connected for the duration of the project, and stay abreast with updates. A BBM Group is perfect for this, provided they all have BlackBerrys! It doesn't